Hearth OS

Progress report · version 0.24.0 · 19 October 2026

Hearth OS turns a living-room PC into a TV-style home screen for Steam, emulation, streaming apps and Quick Resume, driven by a controller, a TV remote or a Wii Remote. It's built on Bazzite and installs as a system image that updates itself and can always be rolled back. It runs on AMD and Intel graphics; NVIDIA is left for later.

19,148	537	27	30	16
lines of code	automated tests	versions released	pull requests merged	guides in docs/

Since 0.23.0: code +1,887, tests +79. Tested on: Ryzen 7 5800X3D, Radeon RX 6750 XT, 24 GB, 256 GB SATA SSD, Xbox controller, Wii Remotes on a DolphinBar.

What's new in 0.24.0

- **Cast from your phone**: the PC shows up on your Wi-Fi as a screen and a speaker. AirPlay from an iPhone, iPad or Mac (a video, photos, music or the whole screen: it comes to the front, and goes away when you stop), Spotify Connect (pick the PC in the Spotify app; Premium), and YouTube with a TV code. Settings → Casting names it and turns each part on or off; Quick Menu → System → Stop casting drops the phone.
- **Your phone as a remote**: Settings → Phone remote shows a code and a QR code; the page (nothing to install) has a d-pad, the buttons and a keyboard, so Wi-Fi passwords, searches and sign-ins are typed on the phone. *hearthctl type* types from a terminal the same way.
- **Your photos in the screen saver**: a folder, or a plugged-in drive's pictures, on their own or mixed with your games' art, the right way up (Settings → Home screen).
- **Accessibility**: Settings → Accessibility: larger text (two sizes) and a high-contrast look, each person's own.
- **A new livery, Girth OS**: wider by design. Settings → Appearance; the header says so under a G roundel, the boot logo is the roundel too, and the tiles really are wider.
- **Two icons on the desktop**: **Hearth** goes back to the TV, and **Steam Gaming Mode** starts Game Mode with Steam's own interface for that one session (Hearth is back the next time). Bazzite's "Return to Gaming Mode" stays and lands on Hearth too.
- **Lighter and sturdier**: the Quick Menu draws in two thirds of the time it took (it no longer repaints the whole screen every frame once it's open) and Settings in half; text that's cut or wrapped is remembered rather than measured again each frame. A review of the whole codebase fixed the things that could go wrong quietly: a phone's music no longer lets the PC fall asleep; receivers that crash or install after boot come back by themselves; the phone remote only answers requests for this PC by name or address, changes its code after repeated guessing, and keeps working when the display can't be reached; an encrypted system drive is never offered for erasing; a mistyped setting is a plain "config error" rather than a crash; background work that fails is logged instead of lost.
- **Fixes from the third field run**: the system drive can no longer be offered for erasing when lsblk lists partitions flat (util-linux 2.41); spotifyd installs again (its checksum file is named after the build), and Settings says so when the install failed; *hearthctl type* and the phone keyboard no longer drop doubled letters; Home from the Quick Menu over Kodi or Heroic closes the menu at once; Search's delete hint names Backspace with a keyboard; long names are cut or wrapped instead of drawn under switches, values and percentages, also at the larger text sizes; arrows the font hasn't got draw as chevrons; a controller whose battery level is unknown no longer shows an empty outline.

What's working

Area	What it does	Status
Home screen	TV-style rows, six liveries (Girth OS is the parody), a drawing or icon on every tile, a backdrop from the focused game, controller batteries and network by the clock	**Confirmed on the PC**
Emulation	ES-DE with a tile per console; emulators tuned for the GPU and TV; game art found automatically	**Confirmed on the PC** (Dolphin working)
Wii Remote	DolphinBar pointer on the home screen and as a mouse; handed to Dolphin for Wii games	**Confirmed on the PC** (pointer working)
Quick Resume	Hold Guide to pause a game and pick it up later (up to 3)	**Confirmed on the PC**
Quick Menu	Guide button panel: audio, per-app volume, Discord, stats, power, updates, screenshots	**Confirmed on the PC**
Streaming	YouTube (VacuumTube), Twitch (VacuumStream), Kodi, Jellyfin, Plex, Moonlight	**Confirmed on the PC**
Game stores	Epic Games (Heroic), Battle.net, EA app and Ubisoft Connect (Lutris) tiles; their games in the Library	**Shipped**
Customising	Favorites with X, move tiles, hide tiles, liveries, sounds	**Confirmed on the PC**
Search and details	Search every app and game; Y on a game for play time and last played	**Confirmed on the PC**
Settings	Wi-Fi, static IP and DNS, Bluetooth, audio devices, storage (format and use a new drive)	**Confirmed on the PC**
Captures	Screenshots from the Quick Menu, a gallery tile, in the screen saver	**Confirmed on the PC**
Watch next	Shows and films in progress from Jellyfin, Plex and Kodi; resumes and reports back	**Shipped**
Family	Daily game-time limit, bedtime and locked tiles behind a PIN, per person	**Shipped**
Privacy	No ads or tracking; a guide to turn off the TV's own tracking, by make	**Shipped**
TV control (CEC)	TV on and to the right input on wake and on Guide; standby with the PC	**Shipped**
Performance	Hearth idles under 2% of one core and about 300 MB; the Quick Menu draws in 7 ms a frame and Settings in 5; hearthctl footprint	**Confirmed on the PC**
Updates	Automatic, versioned, with releases on GitHub, a what's-new card and rollback	**Confirmed on the PC**
People	Who's playing? (at start, after sleep, from the Quick Menu) with optional PINs; own favorites, colour scheme, Continue, Steam and Discord; limits set by an admin	**Shipped**
Casting	AirPlay (video, photos, music, screen mirroring), Spotify Connect, YouTube with a TV code; Quick Menu → Stop casting	**Shipped**
Phone remote	A page on the home network with a d-pad, the buttons and a keyboard, paired with a code and QR code on the TV	**Shipped**
Accessibility	Larger text (two sizes) and a high-contrast look, each person's own; your own photos in the screen saver	**Shipped**
Desktop Mode	Holding Guide, or the Hearth icon on the desktop, returns to the TV; a Steam Gaming Mode icon runs Steam's interface for one session	**Shipped**
Folders	Groups of tiles	**Not started** (deferred for now)

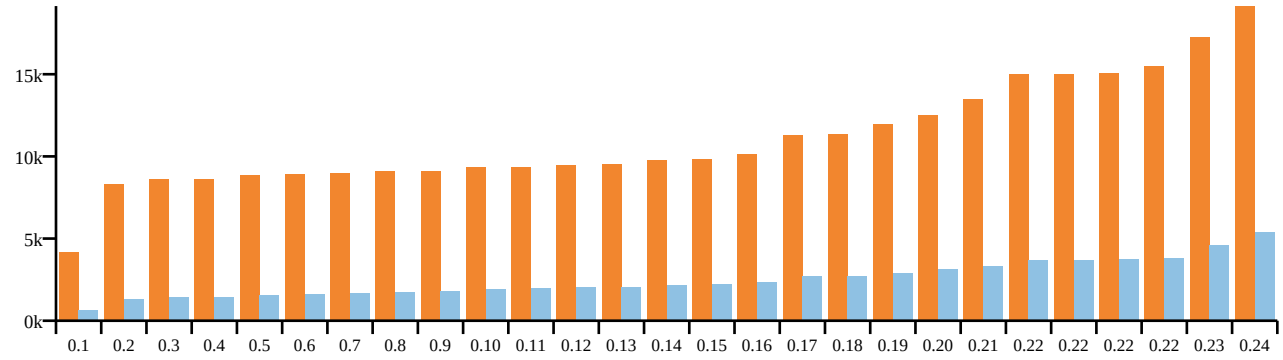
Area	What it does	Status
NVIDIA graphics	A separate image with NVIDIA's driver	**Not started** (deferred: AMD and Intel first)
Netflix and similar	DRM limits these to low quality on any home-built PC	**Not possible**

Confirmed means reported working on the real PC; Shipped means built, tested and released, but not yet reported on.

Lines of code by part

Part	Lines
Home screen, Quick Menu and settings (Python)	16,363
System image (scripts, services, config)	1,380
Build and tools	1,405
Tests	7,447

Growth



Lines of code (orange) and automated tests (blue, ×10) at each version.

Open issues

Issue	Where it stands	What's needed
A Steam game started cold from its tile stayed on Steam's spinner (Sekiro)	Seen once in the field tests (#40); the cause isn't known yet	The same game from Steam's own Game Mode, and PROTON_LOG=1
Steam "Switch to Desktop" can still hang	Holding Guide for 4 s always gets you home; the cause isn't known	hearthctl status and hearthctl logs right after it happens
0.24.0 not yet tried on the PC	Casting, the phone remote, photos in the screen saver and accessibility are built and tested in a virtual display	Update to the staging build, then the field tests again (docs/FIELD_TESTS.md)

Next

- Fix what turns up on the real PC.
- Spoken menus; picture and sound settings (frame-rate matching, night mode); RetroAchievements; save backups.

- When wanted: groups of tiles; NVIDIA support.

Every version

Version	Date	Lines of code	Tests	Docs (lines)	Pull requests
0.24.0	2026-10-19	19,148	537	2,146	30
0.23.0	2026-10-01	17,261	458	1,979	28
0.22.4	2026-09-30	15,485	381	1,773	27
0.22.2	2026-09-30	15,066	374	1,556	26
0.22.1	2026-09-30	15,008	370	1,548	25
0.22.0	2026-09-29	15,005	369	1,544	24
0.21.0	2026-09-29	13,506	334	1,371	23
0.20.0	2026-09-29	12,533	312	1,260	20
0.19.0	2026-09-29	11,984	291	1,120	19
0.18.0	2026-09-29	11,370	270	1,067	18
0.17.0	2026-09-29	11,288	268	1,034	17
0.16.0	2026-09-29	10,159	233	1,022	16
0.15.0	2026-09-29	9,817	223	971	15
0.14.0	2026-09-29	9,741	218	969	14
0.13.0	2026-09-29	9,507	205	954	13
0.12.0	2026-09-27	9,474	201	954	12
0.11.0	2026-09-27	9,339	195	953	11
0.10.0	2026-09-27	9,326	194	940	10
0.9.0	2026-09-27	9,111	179	906	9
0.8.0	2026-09-27	9,072	173	904	8
0.7.0	2026-09-27	8,970	165	901	7
0.6.0	2026-09-27	8,931	163	901	6
0.5.0	2026-09-27	8,836	157	897	5
0.4.0	2026-09-27	8,598	144	888	4
0.3.0	2026-09-27	8,597	141	886	3
0.2.0	2026-09-27	8,336	132	865	2
0.1.0	2026-09-25	4,155	66	703	1